

to use app for data collection. The app also allows you to set specific fitness goals, the progress of which can be tracked using interesting graphs.

One function the Jawbone lacks is some form of wireless connectivity such as Bluetooth or WiFi. The task of constantly connecting the band to your phone via the headphone jack may seem cumbersome to some people. You can charge the device via a USB to 3.5mm adaptor provided with the box. It has an estimated battery life of about 10 days, which means you do not have to use the adaptor as often as you would for other similar smartbands.

Microsoft Band

Microsoft has delved into the fitness market by introducing the Microsoft Health platform, which includes a set of apps and software designed to improve a daily user's overall fitness and lifestyle by implementing technology-based solutions. On the forefront of this platform is Microsoft's first smartband offering, not too subtly titled, the Microsoft Band.

In terms of design, the Microsoft Band strongly resembles a wrist-watch with a condensed but sleek display. It is slightly bulkier than other smartbands and may take some getting used to for most users. In fact, the placement of the buttons forces you to wear the band on your dominant hand's wrist with the display on the inside, exposing it to potential damage since it is very easy to accidentally bump it on a table while you're typing or writing.

Internally, the Band houses a number of sensors, including some not seen in other smartbands such as GPS and an ambient light sensor. The Band also includes a UV sensor that can alert you when you need to apply some sunscreen. The heart rate sensor can also detect changes in your anxiety level, letting you know that you should take a deep breath before you jump into a stressful work day. Battery life is below average when compared with other smartbands in the market. It has about 2 days of life on a single charge.

It pairs with your smartphone using Bluetooth, and requires the Microsoft Health app installed for syncing sensor data. In case you were wondering, yes the app is also available for iOS and Android devices, and not just Windows phone. The advantage of using a Microsoft product does shine in terms of software interconnectivity, since you can use Cortana to communicate with the Microsoft Health app, which is also available on Windows PC. The health app also includes some excellent workout